

Travel & Expense Policy Manual

Governing rules for employee expense claims, reimbursement limits, prohibited categories, and audit procedures.

Version: **2.1**

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Owned By: **Finance & Compliance**

Applies To: **All full-time and contract employees**

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1. Purpose & Scope

This Policy governs all business-related expenses incurred by employees on behalf of the organization. It defines what may be claimed, sets monetary limits by category and seniority level, and establishes the audit rules applied by the ExpenseAuditor platform. Compliance is mandatory. Expenses submitted outside these guidelines will be automatically flagged or rejected by the AI audit engine.

This policy applies to all full-time employees, contractors, and consultants who submit expense claims through the employee portal. It supersedes all prior versions.

2. Employee Grade Levels

Spending limits vary by employee grade. The audit engine uses the grade submitted with each claim to determine the applicable limit. Submitting an incorrect grade constitutes a policy violation.

Grade	Title	Description
E-1 / E-2	Junior Associate / Associate	Entry-level individual contributors
E-3 / E-4	Senior Associate / Team Lead	Mid-level professionals
E-5	Manager	People managers, project owners
E-6	Senior Manager / Principal	Senior leaders, cross-functional leads
E-7	Director	Department heads
E-8	VP / Senior VP	Vice Presidents
E-9	C-Suite / MD	C-level executives, Managing Directors

3. Meal Allowances

Meal limits below are per-person per-meal unless stated otherwise. Claims involving multiple attendees must list all names. The per-head limit is multiplied by the number of confirmed attendees by the audit engine.

3.1 India — Per Meal Limits (INR)

City	E-1/2	E-3/4	E-5	E-6	E-7	E-8	E-9
Mumbai	350	600	900	1,200	1,600	2,000	2,500
Delhi / NCR	350	600	900	1,200	1,600	2,000	2,500
Bengaluru	300	550	850	1,100	1,450	1,800	2,200
Pune	280	500	800	1,050	1,400	1,750	2,100
Hyderabad	280	500	800	1,050	1,400	1,750	2,100
Chennai	260	480	750	1,000	1,350	1,700	2,000
Kolkata	250	450	700	950	1,300	1,650	1,950
Tier-2 City	200	380	600	800	1,100	1,400	1,700
Other / Unknown	180	350	550	750	1,000	1,300	1,600

3.2 International — Per Meal Limits (USD)

Region	E-1/2	E-3/4	E-5	E-6	E-7	E-8	E-9
United States	25	40	60	80	110	140	180
United Kingdom	22	36	55	75	100	130	165
Europe (Schengen)	20	34	52	70	95	120	155
Singapore	22	36	55	75	100	130	165
UAE / Dubai	20	35	55	72	98	125	160
Southeast Asia	15	25	40	55	75	100	130
Other	15	24	38	52	70	90	120

- Alcohol is NOT reimbursable under any meal claim regardless of grade.
- Team meals (3+ people) must include the list of attendees and business purpose in the justification field.
- Meal claims on weekends require explicit manager pre-approval attached to the submission.
- Delivery / room-service meals are capped at 80% of the applicable dine-in limit.

4. Accommodation Limits

Hotel limits are per-room per-night (including taxes). Employees must book through the approved travel portal where possible. Claims above the limit require pre-approval from the reporting manager.

4.1 India — Hotel Limit per Night (INR)

City / Region	E-1/2	E-3/4	E-5	E-6	E-7	E-8	E-9
Mumbai / Delhi	3,500	5,000	7,000	9,000	12,000	16,000	22,000
Bengaluru	3,000	4,500	6,500	8,500	11,000	14,500	20,000
Pune / Hyd / Che	2,800	4,000	6,000	8,000	10,500	14,000	18,500
Tier-2 City	2,000	3,200	4,800	6,500	8,500	11,000	15,000
Other	1,800	2,800	4,200	5,800	7,500	10,000	13,500

4.2 International — Hotel Limit per Night (USD)

Region	E-1/2	E-3/4	E-5	E-6	E-7	E-8	E-9
United States	150	200	250	320	400	500	700
United Kingdom	140	185	230	300	375	470	650
Europe (Schengen)	130	175	215	280	355	450	620
Singapore / HK	145	190	240	310	390	490	680
UAE / Dubai	140	185	230	300	375	470	650
Southeast Asia	90	130	170	220	280	360	500
Other	80	115	155	200	255	330	460

5. Transport & Travel

5.1 Air Travel

Route	E-1/2	E-3/4	E-5	E-6	E-7	E-8	E-9
Domestic (India)	Economy	Economy	Economy	Business	Business	Business	Business
International <6h	Economy	Economy	Economy	Economy	Business	Business	Business
International >6h	Economy	Economy	Economy	Business	Business	Business	First

- Flights must be booked at least 7 days in advance unless operationally urgent (requires manager note).
- Premium Economy is permissible for E-5 and above on international routes over 8 hours.
- Seat upgrade charges are NOT reimbursable unless the base class is entitled.

5.2 Ground Transport (INR per trip)

Mode	E-1/2	E-3/4	E-5	E-6	E-7	E-8	E-9
Airport Taxi (domestic)	800	800	1,200	1,500	2,000	2,500	Any
Cab / Rideshare (city)	400	400	600	800	1,200	1,500	Any
Auto / Local	200	200	200	300	500	500	Any
Mileage (personal car)	INR 5/km	INR 5/km	INR 6/km	INR 7/km	INR 8/km	INR 8/km	INR 10/km

6. Entertainment & Client Expenses

Client entertainment is permitted only when there is a clear, documented business purpose. All claims must include the names of external attendees and their organization.

Category	E-1/2	E-3/4	E-5	E-6	E-7	E-8	E-9
Client Meal (India, INR/head)	—	—	1,800	2,500	3,500	5,000	Any
Client Meal (International, USD/head)	—	—	80	120	175	250	Any
Corporate Gift (INR per recipient)	—	—	1,500	2,500	4,000	6,000	Any
Event / Conference tickets (INR)	—	2,000	3,500	5,000	8,000	12,000	Any

— denotes not permitted at that grade without explicit VP-level pre-approval.

7. Prohibited Expenses

The following categories are NEVER reimbursable regardless of grade, business purpose, or managerial approval:

- Alcohol, tobacco, or controlled substances
- Personal grooming (haircuts, spa, wellness treatments)
- Traffic fines, parking penalties, or legal violations
- Personal subscriptions (Netflix, Spotify, gym, etc.)
- Gifts to employees (covered separately under HR policy)
- Political or charitable donations
- First-class travel for grades E-1 through E-7
- Expenses for family members or non-employees unless pre-approved client entertainment
- Casino, gambling, or adult entertainment
- Expenses without a valid receipt (no receipts = no reimbursement)
- Claims submitted more than 60 days after the expense date

8. Receipt & Submission Requirements

Receipt format	JPG, PNG, or PDF. Minimum 300 DPI. Must be legible.
Required fields	Merchant name, date, itemized amounts, total, currency.
Justification	Business purpose must be stated in plain text (min 10 words).
Submission window	Within 30 days of expense. Hard deadline: 60 days.
Multi-person claims	List all attendee names and their grade/company.
Currency	Claim in original currency; system converts at RBI/ECB rate on expense date.
Duplicate detection	System flags receipts with matching vendor + date + amount within 90 days.

9. Audit Verdicts: Approved / Flagged / Rejected

Every claim is evaluated by the ExpenseAuditor AI engine. The engine compares extracted receipt data against this policy and assigns one of three verdicts.

APPROVED	The claim is fully compliant. Amount is within policy limits for the stated grade, category, and city. Reimbursement is processed within 5 business days.
FLAGGED	The claim could not be fully audited. Common causes: no matching policy rule found for the location/grade, total amount unreadable from receipt, or missing justification. A Finance auditor will review manually within 3 business days.
REJECTED	The claim violates policy. The amount exceeds the applicable limit, or the category is prohibited. A one-sentence rejection reason citing the specific rule is generated. The employee may raise a dispute (see Section 10).

10. Override & Dispute Process

Employees may dispute a REJECTED verdict within 14 days of notification. Finance auditors may override any AI decision with a written justification recorded in the system.

- Employee submits a dispute via the Audit Detail View, including additional context or corrected receipt.
- The claim is escalated to the reporting manager for endorsement (2 business days).
- Finance auditor reviews the manager-endorsed dispute and makes a final ruling (3 business days).
- If upheld: claim is APPROVED and reimbursed. If denied: employee is notified with reasons.
- Disputes involving amounts above INR 50,000 / USD 1,000 are escalated to the Finance Controller.

11. Policy Violations & Consequences

Severity	Consequence
Minor (first offence)	Informal warning. Claim rejected and returned.
Repeated minor violations	Formal written warning. HR notified.
Intentional misrepresentation	Claim recovery + disciplinary action up to termination.
Fraud (fabricated receipts)	Immediate termination and potential legal action.

This document is effective as of 05 April 2026. It is subject to revision at the discretion of Finance & Compliance. All employees are bound by the latest version published on the intranet.